

DecisionBrief — Conversation Transcript

Scenario: business-insurance • Commercial Cleaning • 12 Employees • 3 Vans • \$2M GL Required

2026-05-14 03:10 PM

DecisionBrief: Thinking about business insurance? Tell me about your business and what coverage you're evaluating?

You: I own a commercial cleaning company in Austin — 12 W2 employees, 3 vans, about \$1.2M annual revenue. We clean office buildings and some medical offices — about 35 accounts. Currently we have \$1M/\$2M general liability with NEXT for \$1,200/year, but vans are on personal auto and we have no workers comp, no umbrella, no inland marine for \$25k of floor machines and vacuums.

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DecisionBrief: Got it — 12 W2 employees, 3 vans, \$1.2M revenue, 35 accounts, \$1M/\$2M GL with NEXT \$1,200/yr, no workers comp. no commercial auto. no umbrella. What triggered the need to re-evaluate now?

You: Two things — last month we lost a bid for a 20-location chain because we couldn't provide \$2M GL with additional insured plus workers comp certificate in 24 hours. And two weeks ago a driver backed our van into a client's loading dock — \$4,200 damage, and our personal auto denied it because van is used for business. Also new clients are requiring waiver of subrogation and additional insured, and I don't know how to get COIs fast.

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DecisionBrief: Understood — lost 20-location bid due to \$2M GL + workers comp COI requirement, \$4,200 dock damage denied on personal auto, new clients requiring additional insured and waiver. What do you have today and what has happened with claims?

You: Today just \$1M/\$2M GL with NEXT, \$1,200/year, \$500 deductible. No workers comp — I thought they were contractors but CPA says they are W2. No commercial auto — 3 Ford Transits on my personal State Farm. No umbrella, no inland marine for \$25k equipment. Claims: 2023 floor wax damage \$8k GL claim covered, 2024 fender bender \$3k auto claim on personal, not covered for business use. NEXT renewal coming June 30.

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DecisionBrief: Clear — \$1M/\$2M GL only, no workers comp, 3 Transits on personal, no umbrella or inland marine, 2023 \$8k GL claim. 2024 \$3k auto denied for business use. renewal June 30. What's your budget and constraints?

You: Currently \$3,500/year total for GL plus personal auto portion for vans. Can go to \$8k hard cap \$12k if perfect annually, monthly payments needed, can't do big upfront. Deductible ideally under \$1k. Need audit that isn't a surprise — heard workers comp audit bills \$4k extra if misclassified. Also need agent who can issue COI with additional insured in 24 hours, not 3 days. Need coverage live by June 30 before renewal.

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DecisionBrief: Got it — \$3,500 now, \$8k cap \$12k perfect, monthly payments, under \$1k deductible, audit surprise worry. 24-hour COI need. live by June 30. What must the new coverage actually do?

You: Must have \$2M general liability with additional insured and waiver of subrogation capability for client contracts, workers comp for 12 employees janitorial class code 9014 with no contractor exclusion, commercial auto for 3 vans at least \$500k CSL, umbrella \$2M over GL and auto, inland marine \$25k for floor machines, and fast COI issuance. Also need someone who handles class code correctly so we aren't misclassified, and covers medical offices cleaning exposure.

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DecisionBrief: Understood — \$2M GL with additional insured + waiver, workers comp 12 employees class 9014, commercial auto 3 vans \$500k CSL, \$2M umbrella, \$25k inland marine, fast COI, correct class for medical offices. What worries you most about this decision?

You: Buying cheap online and getting hit with workers comp audit \$4k extra at year end, claim denied because van was personal auto or contractor vs W2 issue, paying for overlapping coverages twice, slow agent who can't get COI in 24 hours losing that 20-location chain again, and buying \$2M umbrella that doesn't actually cover GL and auto together. Also medical office client says we need professional liability or we lose them.

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DecisionBrief: Thanks — audit surprise, claim denied for personal auto and W2 vs contractor, overlapping coverage cost, slow COI losing client, umbrella not covering both, medical office extra coverage are key. What does success look like in 12 months?

You: In 12 months we signed the 20-location chain and didn't lose any bids due to insurance, all COIs with additional insured issued within 24 hours, workers comp audit clean with no extra \$4k bill, commercial auto covering 3 vans with no gaps — that \$4,200 dock damage would be covered, inland marine covered \$25k equipment if van stolen, total under \$8k/year, umbrella \$2M active, and I can sleep knowing medical offices are covered. And no contract lost because of waiver of subrogation.

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DecisionBrief: I have enough information to prepare your Decision Brief.